of that clinic, I haven't been the same. I think it was evident on the tour to Australia in 2009. I mean, I couldn't wait to get to Australia, because I knew it was probably going to be my last tour there with the Proteas. We're not scheduled to play in Australia again until September/October 2011, and it's unlikely I'll be part of the Proteas set-up after the 2011 World Cup in February and March.

As I was no longer in the Test team, I should've just gone out there and had a blast, but instead I was thinking about the team's welfare and ended up playing way too tentatively in the first two 20/20 games. And in the first ODI, I scored 22 off 28 balls. In the second ODI we weren't chasing a hell of a total, but I put the team first again. I thought, 'Well, if you just bat for 40 overs, it should be fine.' And then I tried a pull shot and got caught. It was a half-arsed, overly tentative shot. I was out for 19 off 37 balls. Not great.

For the third game, I was like, 'This is bullshit, I'm just going to go out there and blast away.' The result: 65 off 52 balls. Although I admit I wasn't thinking about the team at all, I did score the runs.

On the other hand, my newfound calm has also worked in my favour – particularly at the Cobras, where we won the Standard Bank Pro20 competition and played in the inaugural Champions League Twenty20 in 2009. The more I settle into the number three batting position, the more I'm figuring out that I am responsible for seeing an innings through. It's not exactly my personality to play like this, but ja, I can see a calmer sort of Herschelle at the wicket these days.

So that's my dilemma. Being too tentative does not work for me … but I also feel the need to assume more responsibility and bat through an innings. It might eventually boil down to just making sure that I play the kind of innings appropriate to the game. Some days I'm going to have to bat through, and other days I'm going to be charging.

Even in 20-over cricket, the basic principles still apply. You still need both big partnerships and someone who will take on the bowling during the game, like I have always tried to do. If I walk out and I feel it's going to be my day – I'm seeing the ball like a football and everything is nice and loose – then yes, I am going to hit the ball and play my shots.

If we're in trouble, though, I'm prepared to accept the responsibility to scratch around and bat through. In World Cups I have always played within myself at the start of an innings and then opened up. I'll work it out,